

Rewarding Contributors, Building Role Models: The FSF Awards



Bradley M. Kuhn



Miguel de Icaza



Yukihiro Matsumoto



Harald Welte



Alyssa Rosenzweig



Rob Savoye



Wietse Venema



Ted Ts'o

The Free Software Awards were instituted in the late nineties, and have been awarded to individuals and companies that are true contributors to free software.

The Free Software Foundation will be presenting its 2021 awards for the advancement of free software at the LibrePlanet conference in March 2022. These awards are given each year.

The Free Software Foundation (FSF) is a non-profit with a worldwide mission to promote computer user freedom. “We defend the rights of all software users,” it says. As a part of its activities, it offers three awards — for the advancement of free software, for a project of social benefit, or for an outstanding new free software contributor.

Earlier awards read like a who’s who of contributors to the free software world. In March 2021, the Award for Advancement of Free Software went to CiviCRM, Bradley Kuhn, and Alyssa Rosenzweig.

CiviCRM allows non-profit organisations to manage their mailings and contact databases. It works for the FSF too. Thus, it was seen by the FSF as “allowing charities and non-profit organisations to do their work without being beholden to a particular proprietary software vendor.”

Canadian hacker Alyssa Rosenzweig leads the Panfrost project

to reverse engineer and provide free firmware for the Mali series of GPUs. An Asahi Linux developer, she aims to port GNU/Linux to the Apple M1 processor. Last July, she demonstrated Debian running bare metal on the Apple M1 with a mainline kernel. She also wrote a GNU/Linux client for the Covid-19 contract tracing used in Canada in September 2020.

Kuhn, meanwhile, has worked long to enforce the GNU General Public License (GPL) and to promote copyleft through the Software Freedom Conservancy (which focuses on “ethical technology”).